



FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 38

# OREGON

## WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

*Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — the first cross-state dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Oregon's family courts and child-welfare system.*

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# 59

OREGON FAMILIES ON RECORD · 88  
CHILDREN IMPACTED · 21 MONTHS  
MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING  
TIME

REPORT GENERATED

MAY 10, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED

18 OF 36

COMPILED BY

MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

# OREGON AT A GLANCE.

Across 59 Oregon families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

|                                                                                               |                                                                                                                   |                                                                          |                                                                                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>CHILDREN IMPACTED</div> <div>88</div> <div>57 of 59 families reported child counts</div> | <div>MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN</div> <div>\$189,000</div> <div>median across 22 families reporting 3+ categories</div> | <div>MEDIAN MONTHS LOST</div> <div>21</div> <div>of parenting time</div> | <div>WENT PRO SE</div> <div>54.2%</div> <div>40.7% after running out of money</div> |
| <div>SUBMISSIONS</div> <div>59</div>                                                          | <div>AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY</div> <div>1.5</div>                                                                   | <div>FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN</div> <div>57 of 59</div>               | <div>COUNTIES REPRESENTED</div> <div>18</div>                                       |

## WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Oregon families — and families in every state — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com)

02 THE COST OF OREGON FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

| EXPENSE CATEGORY                                           | RESPONSES | MEDIAN    | MEAN     | TOTAL REPORTED |
|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-----------|----------|----------------|
| Attorney Fees                                              | 37        | \$20,000  | \$99,278 | \$3,673,300    |
| Lost Wages                                                 | 33        | \$15,000  | \$94,273 | \$3,111,000    |
| Other Court Fees                                           | 28        | \$4,000   | \$11,544 | \$323,230      |
| Therapy / Evaluations                                      | 24        | \$1,000   | \$5,250  | \$126,000      |
| Reunification Services                                     | 23        | \$0       | \$1,178  | \$27,100       |
| GAL Fees                                                   | 21        | \$0       | \$8,310  | \$174,500      |
| Asset Loss <sup>1</sup>                                    | 30        | \$22,500  | —        | —              |
| Median Family Burden (22 families reporting 3+ categories) | —         | \$189,000 | —        | —              |

**Median vs. mean:** Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least \$1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

**1. On asset loss:** One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median (\$22,500) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

|                           |                        |       |         |
|---------------------------|------------------------|-------|---------|
| Median months lost        | <div><div></div></div> | 21    | 1.8 yrs |
| Mean months lost          | <div><div></div></div> | 37    | 3.1 yrs |
| Total across all families | <div><div></div></div> | 1,608 | 134 yrs |

## 03 WHO IS REPORTING · OREGON

Most families documenting in Oregon are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children.

## CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

## CASE STATUS

|                                    |  |    |     |
|------------------------------------|--|----|-----|
| Not provided                       |  | 21 | 36% |
| Active case: stuck or delayed      |  | 19 | 32% |
| Case closed: more than 2 years ago |  | 9  | 15% |
| Not in court but still affected    |  | 3  | 5%  |
| Case closed: within last 2 years   |  | 3  | 5%  |

## SYSTEM AFFECTED

|                                      |  |    |     |
|--------------------------------------|--|----|-----|
| Both Family Court and CPS            |  | 32 | 54% |
| Family Court Only                    |  | 10 | 17% |
| CPS (Child Protective Services) Only |  | 9  | 15% |
| Unknown                              |  | 6  | 10% |
| Mental Health Weaponization          |  | 1  | 2%  |

## DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

## TIME IN SYSTEM

|                   |  |    |     |
|-------------------|--|----|-----|
| 1 – 3 years       |  | 15 | 25% |
| 5 – 10 years      |  | 12 | 20% |
| 3 – 5 years       |  | 8  | 14% |
| Over 10 years     |  | 8  | 14% |
| 6 months – 1 year |  | 5  | 8%  |

## CUSTODY STATUS

|                                   |  |    |     |
|-----------------------------------|--|----|-----|
| No Contact / Total Loss of Access |  | 20 | 34% |
| Visitation Only                   |  | 19 | 32% |
| 50/50 Joint                       |  | 7  | 12% |
| Children in Foster Care           |  | 5  | 8%  |
| Full Custody                      |  | 5  | 8%  |

## GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

## TOP COUNTIES

|           |  |   |     |
|-----------|--|---|-----|
| Lane      |  | 6 | 10% |
| Polk      |  | 2 | 3%  |
| Clackamas |  | 2 | 3%  |
| Benton    |  | 2 | 3%  |
| Jackson   |  | 2 | 3%  |
| Multnomah |  | 2 | 3%  |

## TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

|                                                                             |  |    |     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|----|-----|
| Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)         |  | 17 | 29% |
| False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report) |  | 13 | 22% |
| Other                                                                       |  | 5  | 8%  |
| Medical CPS (Medical Child Abuse allegations, disagreement with doctors)    |  | 5  | 8%  |
| Other: (Short answer)                                                       |  | 5  | 8%  |

**04 PARENT VOICES — OREGON**

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Oregon comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.



*Let a mom get temporary full custody of kids with dad only getting supervised visits for false accusations when the judge didn't look to see she has a history of making false accusations to cps*

— JESSICA

**ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS**

False accusations without due process. Unable to appeal without upheld letter from district office.

— OREGON PARENT · PAUL

**MORE VOICES FROM OREGON**

The failed court system has destroyed my children's childhood, removed them from their family, and placed them with founded abusers

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have destroyed mu family .I lost everything .

— DWAN

My family is devastated. They broke me. They enabled heinous abuse. They maligned me, took away my rights, permanently damaged my precious children. The horrors continue without any accountability to the real culpable parties.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Cps and dhs kidnap children. They are are corrupt and allowed to operate unchecked. They destroy life's and families and no one really cares until it happens to them.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed. They ruined a very happy family. Knowing better.

— ERIC

The system has silenced my son and I.

— ELISE

## 04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



*Follow all they want me to do but keep making up false accusations to push out my case and trying to adopt out my youngest*

— STEPHANIE

Traumatized, destroyed, took everything 3x over, PTSD, depression, anxiety, panic attacks, nightmares, rage, anger, pain, heartache, missed time that can't get back

— TAMI

It has destroyed my family and extinguished all trust in our system.

— KRYSTAAL

The judge refused to acknowledge that I was a child and my ex was an adult. Because they decided to give 50/50 custody he abused and molested my child.

— EUNICE

Giving my Grand- baby to the ex- abuser in a drug rehab center as a patient, for 4 to 6months, reading my false Positives as Positive, following the miss leading statements and false accusations . Not following or recognizing the ICWA Law

— SHIELA

I had a child that was a runaway had 2 children and continued to be a runaway until she was 19 my other children have psychological problems and addiction problems because of the abuse during permanent foster I have 4 children 3 of those children now currently live with me as [...]

— KATHIE

Destroyed the family, and the Oregon law requires a 60 mile max for relocation of the mother and the court, another judge Rassetter, allowed them to move to MO, state of.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have ruined my family's connections and has caused more trauma

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

When I asked the court to enforce the parenting plan and protect my child from abuse, the court rewarded perjury and retaliation with custody reversal and legally severed my relationship with my child, causing more harm than had already occurred before court.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

## 04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



*This system has deeply traumatized my young child and me and has torn our lives apart for no legitimate reason causing harm far beyond time itself. This is generational damage.*

— ALEXANDRA

It is psychologically messing up my children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My son is currently a competent and clear 13 year old young man who is speaking out about the current abuse he is experiencing, he tried to fire his attorney with a letter to her and she tried to bury and spun lies about it. The system of family court has only protected the [...]

— CORA

Killed my 14 year old daughter and alienation from my 19 year old

— KELLY

Made be bitter, afraid of relationship, reclusive, non trusting of others

— GREG

It has tore out family apart due to false alligations as well as interfere with parenting and parenting time along with teaching my kids that I'm poor and can't provide for them which is untrue

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Drastically changed our lives on hear say allegations with no due process knowing for a long while the other parent has had issues in the past but allowing what the false accusations to stick and ignore parental alienation and so much precious time stolen away that my son have [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destruction beyond repair. They kidnapped our lives. Ruined them.

— ERIC

This system has destroyed the bonds that I had with my daughters and I have been fighting to get them back but feel like I'm barely hanging on to them.

— TARALEE

## 04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



*Disabled me in 2016 social security didn't find me disabled in 2020 I'm legally disabled from trauma symptoms. Child lost love respect communication. I never gambled before in my life until I attempted to retain funds for a lawyer my life changed dramatic pains suffering. I [...]*

— NICOLE

This system failed to protect my child and instead prolonged harm, rewarded dysfunction, and forced my family into years of trauma and financial devastation while I fought simply to remain in my child's life.

— LAUREN

Took all my boys away from me and sold my last child at birth

— MINUETT

I'm still fighting for my kids in a very unfair system. This has effected me mentally to a tremendous degree of distress and emotional and physical ptsd I know longer feel like I have anyone to protect me as everyone is compromised. It haunts me knowing people can just come and [...]

— DELILAH

Biggest waste of time and money to get nowhere.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It's a shock feeling because I thought the court was going to be fair and as her mother I haven't done anything illegal I always focus on my daughter and don't deserve to be away from my child, I see my child cry to me and when she says she wants mommy I can see how much it has [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ill continue this later. I dont want to lose what I have here but ive done as much ss I can handle tonight . - theres many more for oregons list .

— ANONYMOUS PARENT



## 04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



*This system took my child from me based on lies and bias, and over the past six years I have lost not only my relationship with her but also my stability, support, and sense of self. The separation has affected every part of my life—emotionally, mentally, and financially—leaving [...]*

— SARAH

Stole my child from a family friends home, I wasn't present and never got to even say goodbye. No due process whatsoever.. I haven't seen or spoken to my child since. She was 8 at the time and is now going to be 10 in April.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I have cameras all around my house now. I checked my front door every morning for a CPS card. My son doesn't go to school. We listen completely isolation. I am a mom with 27 cases with the state of Oregon. Only four founded. Yet I live in complete fear every single day. I have a [...]

— ATHENA

Destroyed it, they helped my abuser knowing he was abusive because I have anxiety they told me my mental health was worse but I wasn't even admitted to the hospital for my anxiety and was on no medication and was seeing a counselor and doctor for my anxiety. The courts decided [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has helped my mother to a degree but made her way worse, it help me as a child from her. My grandparents saved me. It helped me get my mom help. Just wish I could have done more for them all before it was too late bi miss them sooo.

— ANGELA

Family court has caused me to lose hope in America, my future, & my kids future. It took the happiest parts of me and turned them to dust. They stole things I can't replace. Time. Memories. My God-given blessing of motherhood. My child. What is more devastating than losing a [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

45 Oregon parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 40 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

**05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — OREGON**

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Oregon families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

Let a mom get temporary full custody of kids with dad only getting supervised visits for false accusations when the judge didn't look to see she has a history of making false accusations to cps

— JESSICA

The failed court system has destroyed my children's childhood, removed them from their family, and placed them with founded abusers

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— SHIELA

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I had a child that was a runaway had 2 children and continued to be a runaway until she was 19 my other children have psychological problems and addiction problems because of the abuse during permanent foster I have 4 children 3 of those children now currently live with me as adults. My sexual orientation at the time was bisexual since then I have turned back to Christ and I am now married to there father my 3 girls CPS used my sexual orientation to keep my children in permanent foster care and now we have 6 grandchildren that have been adopted or currently in foster care do to lies and my childrens disabilities in Oregon, Idaho and Nevada.

— KATHIE

Destroyed the family, and the Oregon law requires a 60 mile max for relocation of the mother and the court, another judge Rassetter, allowed them to move to MO, state of.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

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**05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED**

My son is currently a competent and clear 13 year old young man who is speaking out about the current abuse he is experiencing, he tried to fire his attorney with a letter to her and she tried to bury and spun lies about it. The system of family court has only protected the documented abusive person and protected itself. My son is currently expressing suicidal ideation. The family court is hurting him and forcing him to be where he is afraid and unsafe.

— CORA

Killed my 14 year old daughter and alienation from my 19 year old

— KELLY

Made be bitter, afraid of relationship, reclusive, non trusting of others

— GREG

It has tore out family apart due to false alligations as well as interfere with parenting and parenting time along with teaching my kids that I'm poor and can't provide for them which is untrue

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Drastically changed our lives on hear say allegations with no due process knowing for a long while the other parent has had issues in the past but allowing what the false accusations to stick and ignore parental alienation and so much precious time stolen away that my son have separation anxiety and a lot is still blamed on me while I have less and less time and less time to be apart of his school or anything

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

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— ERIC

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— NICOLE

This system failed to protect my child and instead prolonged harm, rewarded dysfunction, and forced my family into years of trauma and financial devastation while I fought simply to remain in my child's life.

— LAUREN

Took all my boys away from me and sold my last child at birth

— MINUETT

I'm still fighting for my kids in a very unfair system. This has effected me mentally to a tremendous degree of distress and emotional and physical ptsd I know longer feel like I have anyone to protect me as everyone is compromised. It haunts me knowing people can just come and take your kids and make up any reason why.

— DELILAH

Biggest waste of time and money to get nowhere.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

**05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED**

It's a shock feeling because I thought the court was going to be fair and as her mother I haven't done anything illegal I always focus on my daughter and don't deserve to be away from my child, I see my child cry to me and when she says she wants mommy I can see how much it has affected her and I can't do much because her father is high conflict with me I'd rather put her feelings first than mine. It has left me in distress and my family sees me very depressed, I just get stuck on not knowing what to do anymore because all I want is to become stable and have a better future. Another thing the parenting time that was ordered has led me to miss work and spend a lot on lodging and food and gas and I don't make any income and the attorney fees are so expensive I also have to pay child support and my ex makes more than me. My family and me are so heartbroken

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ill continue this later. I dont want to lose what I have here but ive done as much ss I can handle tonight . - theres many more for oregons list .

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— SARAH

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I have cameras all around my house now. I checked my front door every morning for a CPS card. My son doesn't go to school. We listen completely isolation. I am a mom with 27 cases with the state of oregon. Only four founded. Yet I live in complete fear every single day. I have a very descriptive note on my front door exciting I will not take visitors that are unannounced. I leave an email to be contacted at. And I refuse any in person communication with any state personnel unless it goes through email first and foremost.

— ATHENA

**05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED**

Destroyed it, they helped my abuser knowing he was abusive because I have anxiety they told me my mental health was worse but I wasn't even admitted to the hospital for my anxiety and was on no medication and was seeing a counselor and doctor for my anxiety. The courts decided they knew better than my medical team

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— ANGELA

Family court has caused me to lose hope in America, my future, & my kids future. It took the happiest parts of me and turned them to dust. They stole things I can't replace. Time. Memories. My God-given blessing of motherhood. My child. What is more devastating than losing a child. I'll wait....

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system that was meant to protect and serve my family instead became a long, exhausting battle that tested my strength, strained mine and my son's bond for many years, and forced me and my son to endure far more than we ever should have had to.

— JULIE

As mentally and emotionally drained me makes me walk on eggshells they have taken the good parent and bash them to the ground Sidenote in your cost estimates, I tried filling it out and every which way I did it it would put red letters so that part on my survey is incorrect

— TABITHA



**05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED**

This system completely took away my purpose and reason for living. I was raped and to this day never heard from police but it was the first thing in a court room of strangers used against me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

2 of the 4 grown adult children still won't have contact with me. They believe the lies by my ex narcissistic husband. All the children were brought into court and my ex had her testify at age 16 that I deserved to be choked and hit - it was torture. I asked for the children to not be involved in the divorce proceedings to protect them. I was overruled. It caused emotional damage to my children and they still believe it was my fault that they were forced to go to court. He was awarded full custody even though he had a restraining order for putting a gun to my head. Now as adults, two of the four want nothing to do with me. They think that since the court sided with him I am a monster

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Nothing except undue stress

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

45 full approved Oregon comments are included in this appendix.

## 06 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

### WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a national, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Oregon report comes from Oregon respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Oregon — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

### WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 59 Oregon families reporting here are not the universe of Oregon families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. We flag outliers and report medians when means are distorted (see page 3, note 1). The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

### METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – May 2026 through [standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey](https://standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey). Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

When a respondent's financial entry differs from the population by more than three standard deviations, the mean is suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

STANDWITHMEG.COM · COURAGE TO STAND, POWER TO CHANGE

### ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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